COURSE

IB Diploma Programme Business management HL

Leadership and management

Unit 2: Human resource management · 2.3 Leadership and management

Revision for Unit 2: Human resource management: each firm works it out on its own deals.

Class **IB Business Management HL** Topic **Leadership and management**

THE LESSON

Setup	3 min

Round 1 — Decisions 3 min · Deals 5 min · Topic tasks 4 min

Firm decisions	**Deals**	**Topic task 1**	**Topic task 2**

Round 2 — Decisions 3 min · Deals 5 min · Topic tasks 4 min · B2B deal 3 min

Firm decisions	**Deals**	**Topic task 3**	**Topic task 4**	**B2B deal**

Round 3 — Decisions 3 min · Deals 5 min · Topic tasks 4 min · B2B deal 3 min

Firm decisions	**Deals**	**Topic task 5**	**Topic task 6**	**B2B deal**

Final questions	3 min

Fits a 30-minute lesson setting; longer settings add more deals.

Each step

Firm decisions	Each role makes its decision on its own page.
Deals	Each pupil trades with a classmate in another firm.
Topic task	The firm answers together. Everyone presses Agree.
B2B deal	One firm sells a lot of cars to another firm.
Final questions	Each pupil answers six questions.

Firm decisions

CEO	**Staff**	Hire staff. Each costs a salary and gives one benefit.
	Sabotage FROM ROUND 2	Hit a rival firm's cash, at a cost. A Legal Counsel blocks it.
Sales & Marketing	**Marketing**	Book one advert campaign to lift the next sales.
Finance	**Capital & Loans**	Borrow cash. The firm pays it back with interest.
	Investments FROM ROUND 2	Buy property or funds. The value can rise or fall.
Operations	**Seasonal stock**	Order the season's cars in advance.

B2B deal · Rounds 2 and 3

One firm sells a lot of 3 cars to another firm (4 in Round 3). With an odd number of firms, two firms offer to sell and the lower price wins.

Topic tasks

Each firm gets its own figures. The method is the same for every firm.

Task 1

ROUND 1

A manager is autocratic with new trainees but lets the expert team decide alone.

Which approach to leadership is this?

PICK ONE

- ○ Democratic leadership
- ○ Laissez-faire leadership
- ○ Paternalistic leadership
- ✔ **Situational leadership**

Why: Changing style to suit the staff and the task is situational leadership.

Task 2

ROUND 1

A manager decides everything alone and gives orders.

Which two effects are most likely over time?

PICK TWO

- ○ Decisions take longer
- ✔ **Fast decisions in a crisis**
- ✔ **Skilled staff feel undervalued**
- ○ Staff feel more involved
- ○ Staff gain more responsibility

Why: Deciding alone is quick, but skilled staff want a say.

Task 3

ROUND 2

Four leadership styles.

Order them by how much staff decide, least first?

PUT THESE IN ORDER, FIRST TO LAST · RIGHT ORDER

1. **Autocratic**
2. **Paternalistic**
3. **Democratic**
4. **Laissez-faire**

Why: Paternalistic leaders still decide, but explain and consult more than autocrats.

Task 4

ROUND 2

A new laissez-faire manager took over.

Rise in the error rate, as a %?

WORK OUT THE NUMBER, THEN PICK IT · EXAMPLE FIGURES

Deals a month	**200 deals**
Pricing errors before	**16 errors**
Pricing errors now	**24 errors**

METHOD

Rise % = (errors now − errors before) ÷ errors before × 100

(24 − 16) ÷ 16 × 100 = 50%

Why: Little direction suits skilled staff; here errors rose by 50%.

Task 5

ROUND 3

A new, untrained team must deliver a big fleet order by Friday.

Which approach fits, and why?

PICK A OR B AND GIVE A REASON

- ✔ **Clear instructions from the manager**
- ○ Let the team decide how

Why: Untrained staff and little time need clear direction.

Task 6

ROUND 3

A laissez-faire manager runs a team of new trainees. Errors and complaints rise.

What best explains the problem?

PICK ONE

- ○ Decisions are too centralised
- ○ Staff have too little freedom
- ○ The manager is too controlling
- ✔ **Trainees lack the skill to work alone**

Why: Laissez-faire suits skilled, motivated staff; trainees need direction.

Final questions

6
questions for each pupil

109
Level 3 Business questions

2
of them on leadership and management

The game draws 6 of the 109 Level 3 questions; these 2 are about leadership and management.

1 A dealer says managers welcome challenge, but staff say every failed decision is punished. Which cultural effect is most likely?

Staff stop raising risks or new ideas.

2 A safety incident at a branch needs immediate coordinated action. Why might a usually participative leader become more directive for now?

Urgent risk needs fast, clear decisions.